

TWO BOOKS · DISJOINT LETTERS — companion lecture deck

al-Muqatta'āt as a positional pointer — not a code

The honest spine

The disjoint letters mark a CONTIGUOUS block of LONGER, compositionally distinct sūras — a positional and organizational signal that survives permutation nulls and FDR. The folkloric 'code' claims (Qāf-letter saturation, thematic encoding) do NOT survive. Benjamini-Hochberg correction across the whole battery; no miracle claims.

A workbench, not an opinion

29 of 114 sūras open with disjoint letters. Each test below tags those sūras, compares to thousands of random tags of the same size, and reports an FDR-corrected verdict — every number computed live from Book6.

What are al-Muqatta‘āt?

الم · الر · حم · طسم — the disjoint letters opening 29 sūras

The popular view

A hidden cipher: each letter secretly encodes meaning or content.

The testable thesis

A positional / organizational POINTER to a distinct block of sūras.

We test the pointer thesis, and we test the cipher claims too

The letters open 29 sūras and are recited one by one. Rather than assume a code, we tag every sūra muqatta‘āt-bearing or not and ask whether that tag predicts measurable structure — position, size, composition — beyond chance.

Every claim faces a permutation null; the whole battery is then read AFTER Benjamini-Hochberg correction, so no single borderline p is mistaken for a miracle.

The workbench — three scales of question

? Position

contiguity, per-family,
size / geometry

? Sequence

letter density &
letter information

? Semantic

root information,
family lexis

One tag, many lenses

Position asks **WHERE** the marked sūras sit and how big they are; Sequence asks how their **LETTERS** behave; Semantic asks how their **ROOTS** behave. A real pointer should leave a footprint across scales — and the cipher claims should fail under the same nulls.

What this deck will — and will not — do

WILL

- Tag sūras and test each claim against a permutation null.
- Read the battery AFTER FDR.
- Keep only what survives.
- Report the geometry the data licenses.
- Audit each rung ✓ / ✗ / ~.

WILL NOT

- Treat the letters as a decoded cipher.
- Promote a borderline uncorrected p to a finding.
- Read contiguity as theology.
- Offer any parallel as proof.

The method — permutation nulls + FDR

Permutation null

Re-tag 29 random sūras thousands of times; rebuild the statistic each time.

Benjamini-Hochberg

Correct the whole battery of p-values so chance hits don't masquerade as findings.

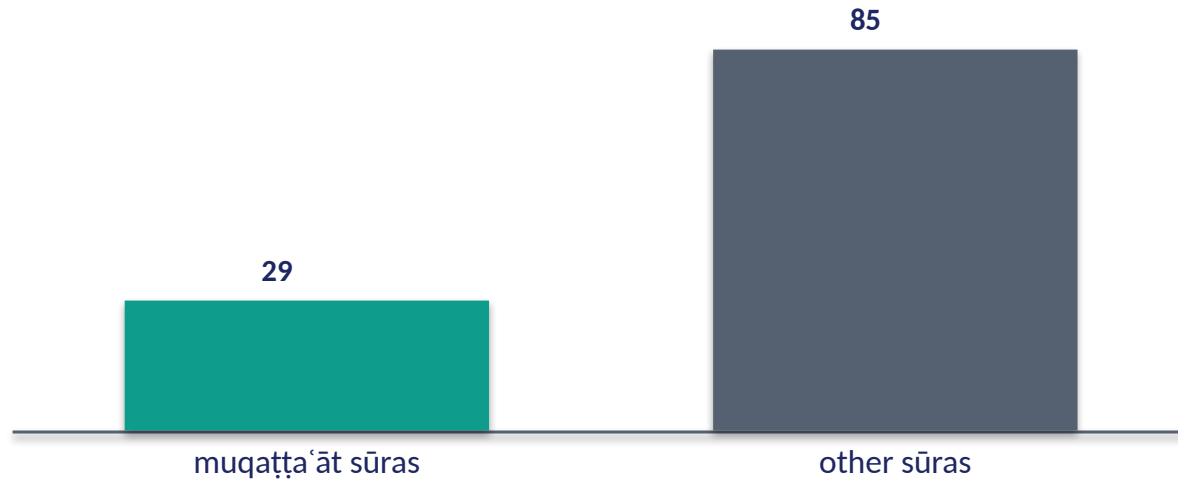
Why FDR is non-negotiable here

Run enough tests and some will cross $p < 0.05$ by chance alone — exactly how folklore manufactures a 'miracle'. Benjamini-Hochberg controls the false-discovery rate across the battery, so a borderline result like the theme test ($p = 0.049$) is correctly demoted once corrected.

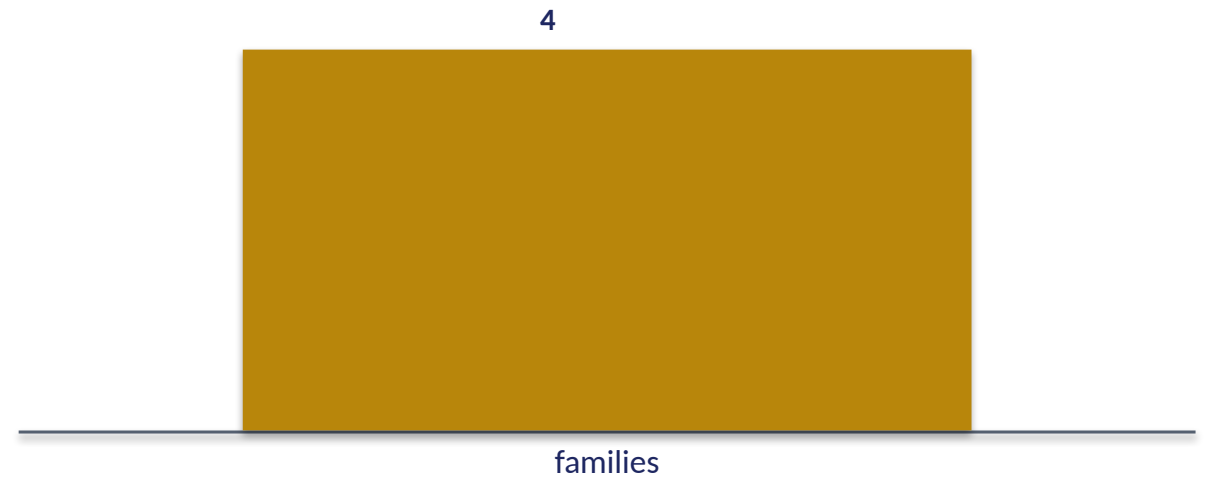
Everything that follows is reported with its FDR-corrected status, never a lone p.

Module 1 — Frame: the 29-sūra tag

The corpus, split by the tag



Distinct opening families



What it is / Why

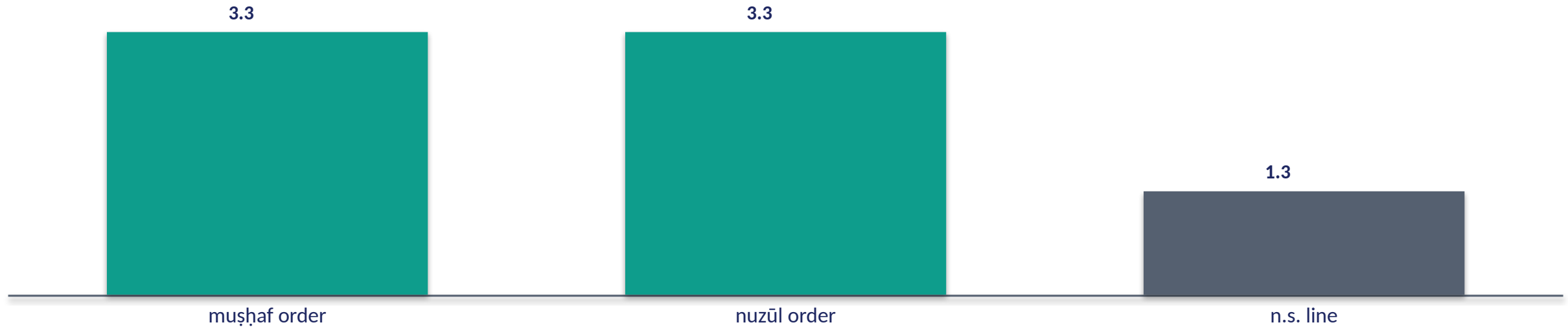
29 of 114 sūras open with disjoint letters, in a handful of distinct families. We tag each sūra and ask whether the tag predicts structure beyond chance.

In the data • Bridge

29 marked vs 85 unmarked sūras — a clean two-group test. First and strongest question: do the marked sūras cluster contiguously?

Module 2 — Contiguity: do the marked sūras cluster?

Contiguity significance ($-\log_{10} p$) — higher = stronger; n.s. line at 1.3



In the data — they cluster, in BOTH orderings

The 29 muqatta'āt sūras are significantly contiguous at $p \approx 0.0005$ in the muṣḥaf order AND $p \approx 0.0005$ in the revelation (nuzūl) order. A result that holds in two independent orderings is far harder to dismiss as an artefact — this is the strongest geometric signal.

Module 3 — Per-family contiguity

How it's done

Repeat the contiguity test WITHIN each letter-family (HM, ALR, ALM, TSM) against the same null.

HM

ALM

ALR

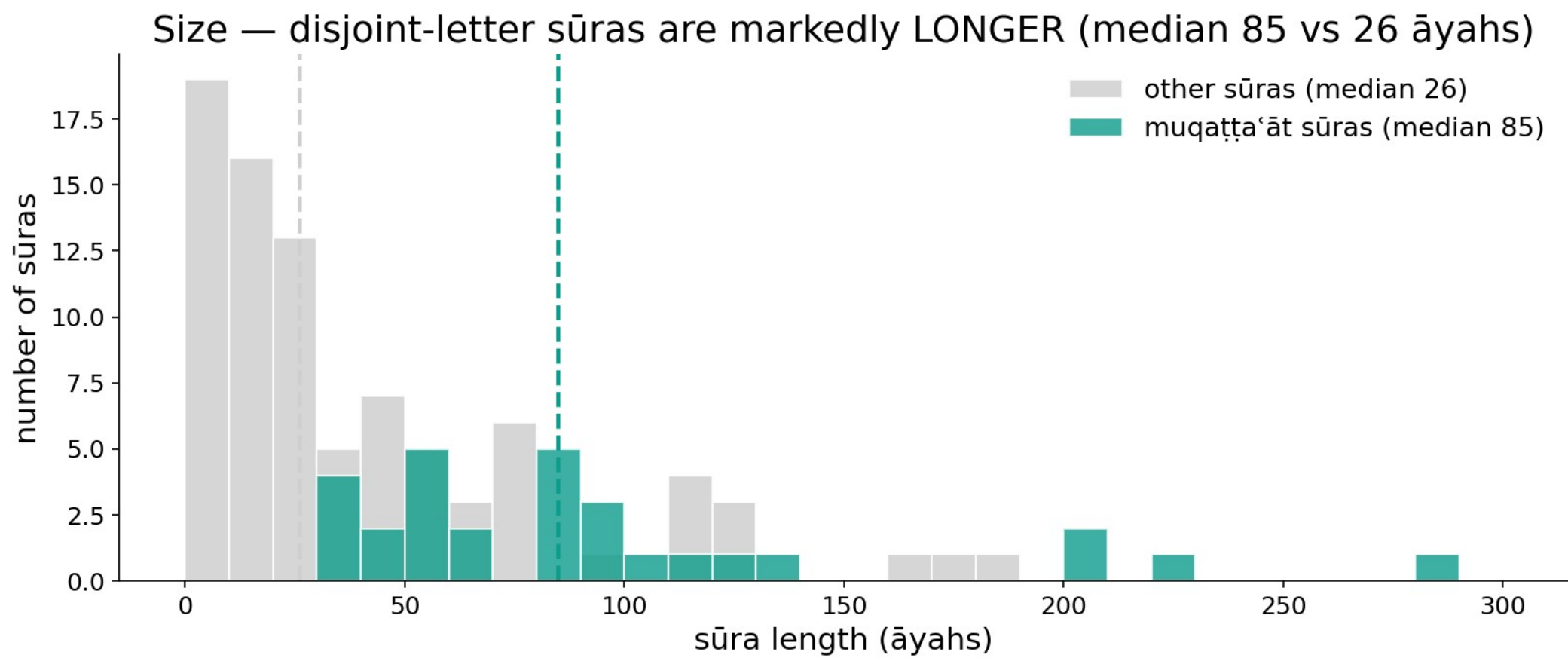
TSM

n.s.

In the data

Every family clusters: HM and ALR at $p \approx 0.0005$, ALM at 0.006, TSM at 0.035. The geometry is family-structured, not one lucky run.

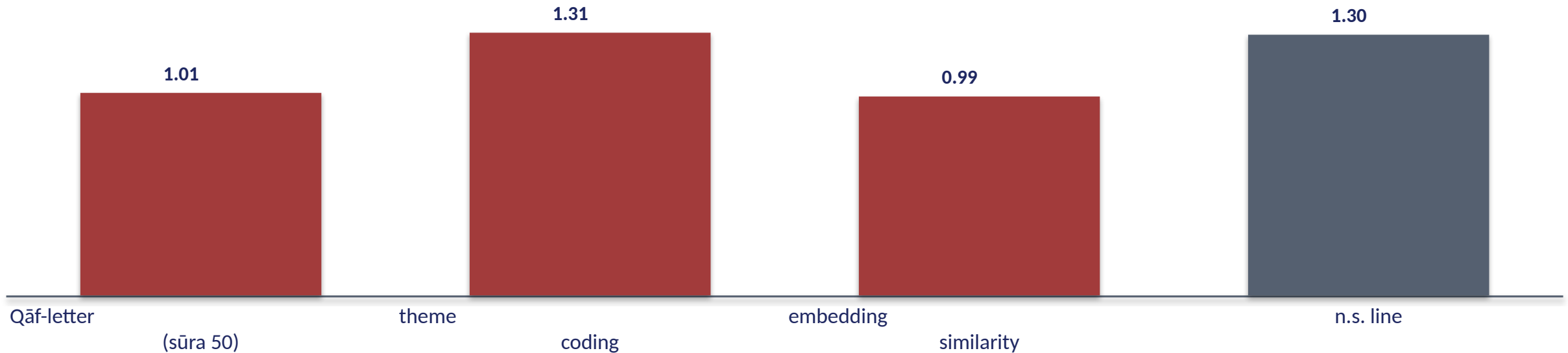
Module 4 — Size: the marked sūras are longer



In the data — the full sūra-length distribution for both groups; the muqatta'āt sūras (teal) sit well to the right — median 85 vs 26 āyahs. A large, consistent size gap, not a handful of outliers.

Module 5 — What it is NOT: the code claims fail

'Code' claims — significance ($-\log_{10} p$); ALL below the n.s. line (1.3)

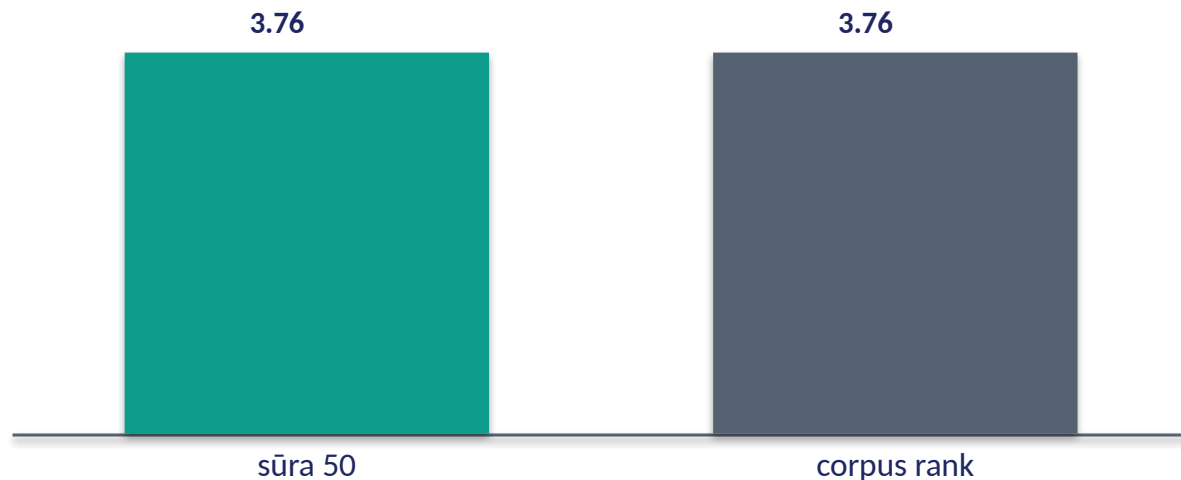


In the data — none survive

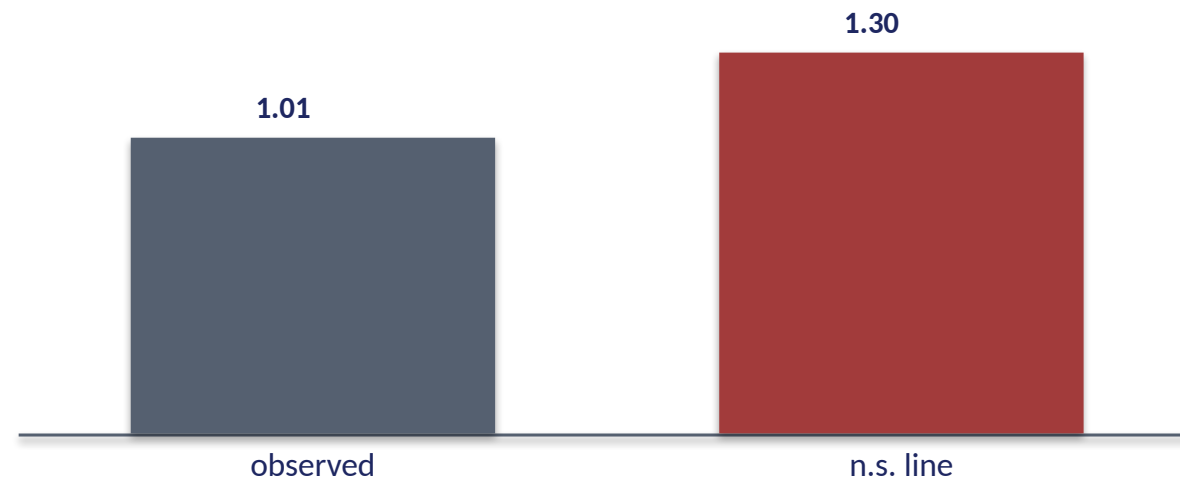
In Sūrat Qāf the letter qāf is 3.76% of letters at $p \approx 0.10$ — NOT significant. The theme test is $p = 0.049$ (borderline, and gone after FDR). The embedding-similarity claim is $p \approx 0.10$. The famous letter-cipher claims are NOT supported.

Module 5 — Anatomy of a myth: Sūrat Qāf

Letter qāf density in sūra 50 (%)



Is it special? ($-\log_{10} p$)



The claim

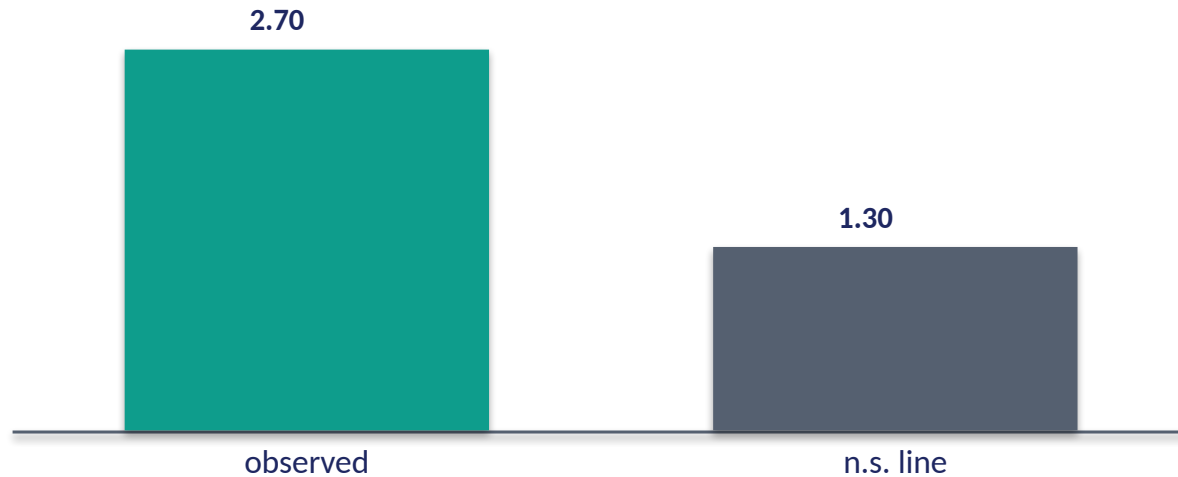
Folklore says Sūrat Qāf is saturated with the letter qāf. Its qāf density is 3.76% — and it ranks 111th of 114 sūras, not 1st.

The test

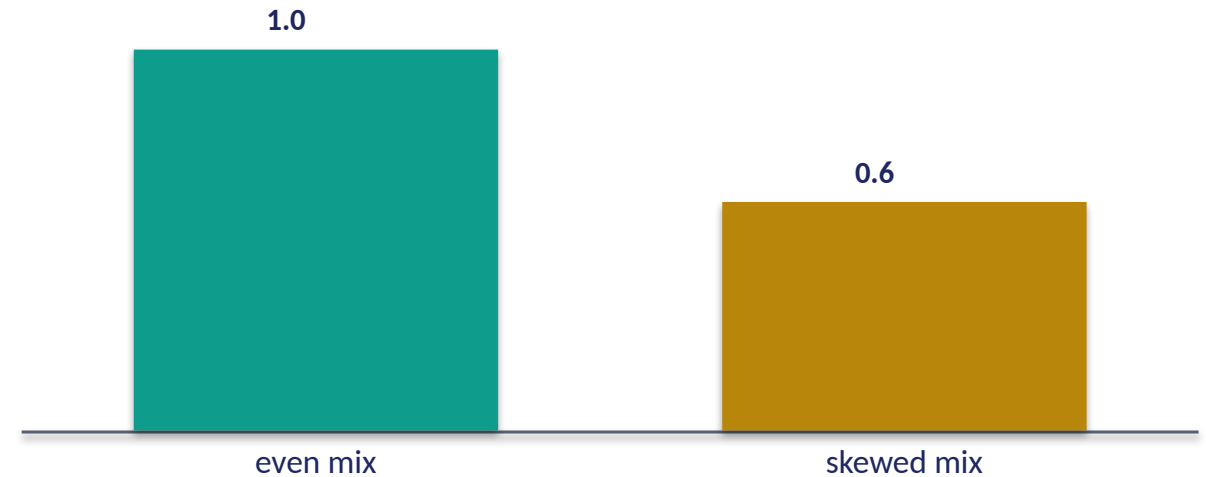
Against a permutation null the elevation is $p \approx 0.10$ — not significant. An attractive story that the data simply does not support.

Module 6 — Letter information theory

Letter-entropy difference — significance ($-\log_{10} p$)



Reference — what entropy measures



How / What we get

Compute the letter-entropy of each group and test the difference against a permutation null.

In the data

The difference is significant at $p \approx 0.002$ — muqaṭṭa'āt sūras are compositionally distinct at the letter scale, not only longer.

Module 7 — Root information theory

How it's done

Compute root-entropy and lexical richness per group; test each against a permutation null.

root entropy

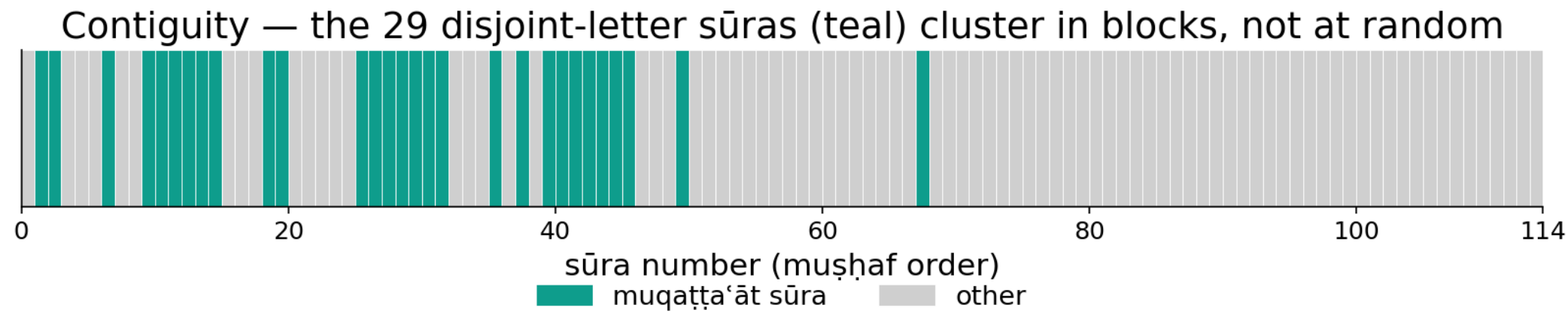
lexical richness

n.s. line

In the data

Root-entropy differs at $p \approx 0.0005$ and lexical richness at $p \approx 0.0005$ — the distinction is sharp at the root scale too. A multi-scale structural signal.

Module 8 — Contiguity you can SEE: the 114-sūra strip



In the data — each cell is one sūra in order; teal = disjoint-letter sūra. They fall in CONTIGUOUS blocks (the ḤM, ALM, ALR families), not scattered — the geometric signal at $p \approx 0.0005$.

Synthesis — pointer, not cipher

Survives (FDR-clean)

Contiguity (0.0005, two orderings), per-family clustering, size 85 vs 26, letter-entropy 0.002, root-entropy & richness 0.0005.

Fails the null / FDR

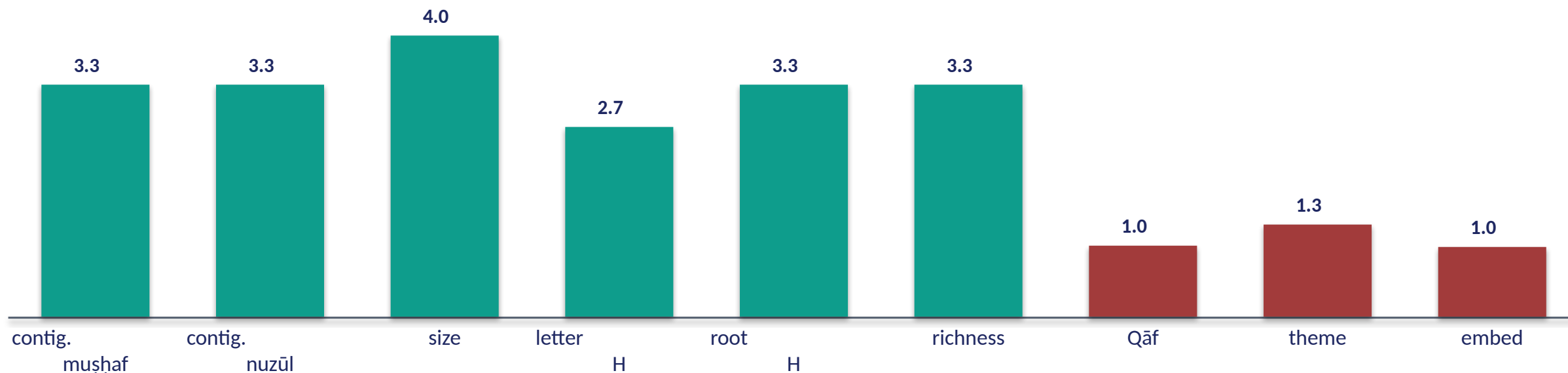
Qāf-letter saturation ($p \approx 0.10$), thematic coding (0.049, gone after FDR), embedding similarity ($p \approx 0.10$).

Honest reading

A geometric and organizational signal marks these sūras as a distinct class — the data does not license a hidden cipher.

The whole battery at a glance

Every test — significance ($-\log_{10} p$). Green survives, red fails; n.s. line at 1.3



Six survive, three fail

The geometric and compositional tests (green) clear the null and FDR; the three cipher claims (red) sit below the n.s. line. One picture of the honest verdict — read the battery together, never a lone p.

Audit — claim by claim

✓ Contiguity ↔ pointer

Significant in two orderings ($p \approx 0.0005$).

✓ Per-family clustering

Every family significant (H_M/ALR sharpest).

✓ Size ↔ architecture

Median 85 vs 26 āyahs.

✓ Composition ↔ distinct class

Letter & root entropy differ (≤ 0.002).

✗ Qāf-letter ↔ cipher

$p \approx 0.10$ — not significant.

~ Theme ↔ encoding

$p = 0.049$, gone after FDR — not supported.

Not a scientific miracle — and not evidence

What we are NOT claiming

The disjoint letters are not a decoded cipher; contiguity is not theology; a borderline uncorrected p is not a finding. We do not claim to know WHY the letters are there — only what measurable structure the tag does and does not predict.

What the workbench IS for

A disciplined way to separate a real geometric/organizational signal from folklore, with a permutation null behind every answer and FDR across the battery. Every number is recomputable live in the app. The findings are judged by reproducibility, never offered as proof of intent.

Quick reference — terms & live numbers

Terms

Muqaṭṭa'āt — disjoint letters opening 29 sūras. Contiguity — clustering of tagged sūras. Permutation null — re-tag random sūras to build the chance distribution. FDR (Benjamini-Hochberg) — battery-wide correction. Letter/root entropy — composition information.

Live Book6 numbers

Contiguity $p \approx 0.0005$ (muṣḥaf & nuzūl) · families ḤM/ALR 0.0005, ALM 0.006, ṬSM 0.035 · median 85 vs 26 āyahs · letter-entropy 0.002 · root-entropy & richness 0.0005 · Qāf 3.76% $p \approx 0.10$ (n.s.).

Close — the geometry the data licenses

The through-line

Tag the 29 sūras and the structure appears: they cluster contiguously in two orderings, they are markedly longer, and they are compositionally distinct at both the letter and the root scale. The attractive cipher claims — Qāf-letter saturation, thematic encoding — do not survive the nulls or FDR.

So the disjoint letters are best read as a validated positional and organizational POINTER, not a hidden code — every claim with its null, every parallel a labelled lens, never evidence.

Next in the series — Signal reads the same corpus as an ordered signal, Biology as a genome; the FDR Summary then collects every Two Books test into one corrected dashboard.